

THE OUTERNET: Information From The Sky



Adil Khan is currently pursuing B.Sc (PCM) from Bundelkhand University. His interests include satellite communication, cyber security and cyber forensic, among others

For 60 per cent of the world's population, regular Internet access is about as common as flying cars but where the Internet has failed, the Outernet hopes to succeed," according to Gizmodo.

The Outernet was founded by Syed Karim on February 1, 2014, in New York, USA. It is supported by Media Development Invest Fund, an impact investment fund that provides finance to ventures involved in news and debates. The fund has invested almost US\$ 130 million in around 105 different companies in more than 36 countries.

The Outernet project aims to provide

a Library In The Sky satellite based service that gives free access to daily download of data like books, videos, music, news and more. The goal is to provide Internet in an easy way to those who do not have easy, affordable or uncensored access.

The Outernet is a free content-distribution system that aims to provide basic Web access, broadcast via a series of geostationary and low-Earth orbit satellites, as well as cubesats using a combination of data-casting and user-datagram protocols. The device would communicate with the satellite and download relevant content.

Given below are some interesting features of the Outernet:

- Global coverage
- Unlimited data broadcasting (currently 1GB/day)
- No subscription/no registration
- Totally anonymous (because receive-only service)
- High-speed data download (tested up to 25Mbps)
- Anyone can request content to be multicast on the Outernet

How the Outernet works

The Outernet downloads files from various sources like Khan Academy, Wikipedia, MIT open courseware and the like, and sends it to its servers. The satellite dish sends this data to the satellites. The satellite broadcasts information back to Earth all over the world.

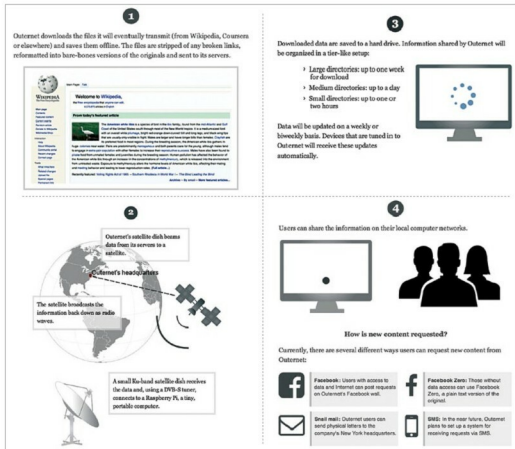


Fig. 1: How the Outernet works (Image courtesy: www.indiegogo.com)